

emulation and as a matter of fact, emulation is slow. VMware Workstation is one product which tries to utilise your graphics hardware to a large extent for availing better 3D support on your guest operating system but still, graphics are not going to be great. In addition to this, the memory utilised by the virtual machine is also in control of the virtualization software and gaming as such is also hard on memory modules. While you might be able to run a few small games (we found *Age of Empires – 2* ran well enough, because it's mostly 2D-based) and a few applications which demand 3D, it's going to need a really powerful system and you can't expect good performance.

Fancy effects

Windows has AERO and Linux has compiz for visual effects and both of them are not going to go well with virtual machines. VMware Workstation can make a Windows Vista or Windows 7 guest go with the AERO interface and Gnome 3 worked as well but don't expect them to run smoothly or be enjoyable. With any other virtualization software, you're down to basic effects only. Transparent Windows, translucent and blurred dashboards and all those compiz effects are great but they don't belong to virtual worlds. They need the touch of reality for them to work.

Testing your hardware for an OS

The only right information you're going to provide to your virtual machine inside a VMware Workstation or VirtualBox is the name of the processor. With VirtualBox, you can put the cap on execution and with Qemu you can fake everything altogether. Think about all of them at once and you might just start feeling like all the virtualization software – VirtualBox, VMware workstation and Qemu are quite the deceivers. Yes, they are indeed. That's their job and what they were “born” to do – lying to an operating system about the hardware. There's no way you can use the word “compatibility” with the words “hardware” and “virtualization” in a single sentence expect in this one. Never think about testing out hardware compatibility of an OS using virtual machines.

When you don't know what you're doing

This is one thing which can ruin everything – a user who is unaware of his or her actions. There are chances that you could use a great tool like virtualization as a weapon to shoot yourself. There are a few times when it can all go wrong. Here are a few of those times: